One Habit at a Time

THE PRACTICAL WORKBOOK

Practice pages and fourteen day records for the eight habits

One cue. One action. Room to reflect.

Shay Eisenberg

How to Use This Workbook

Eight habits practiced in order

Eight habits, practiced in order. A printable companion to the book, with room to notice what helps and return after a miss.

How to use these pages

• Start with your current habit. You do not need to complete the whole workbook at once.

• Use one cue and one required action. Pick environment ideas that make that action easier.

• Print the two pages for that habit, or use the same prompts in a notebook.

• Review after 14 days. Stability matters more than a perfect record.

• Keep earlier habits running when you add the next one. If life interrupts, return at the next cue.

Print only what you need

These pages use US Letter paper, a white background, and light table borders for home printing. Print at actual size on Letter; use Fit to printable area on A4. Each habit starts with a practice page followed by a tracker. Reprint either page whenever useful.

Use the method within your needs

This workbook is for adults and provides general education, not individualized medical or nutrition care. Use your care team's advice about food, fluids, movement, and medication. Do not use a tracker to delay needed food or care. You can skip weight, measurements, or any exercise that increases distress.

My name and the date I begin

My Starting Point

Compare with yourself, not someone else.

Why I want these habits beyond a number on a scale

What already works in my everyday life

My toughest recurring situation

What I want an ordinary Tuesday to feel like

Optional reference points

What I choose to notice	Today
Afternoon energy, in my own words	
Daily function or movement	
Fit of a familiar garment, if useful	
Waist or photo, only if useful	

Skip any body measurement that increases distress. An energy score is a personal reflection, not a medical test.

Habit 1 Practice Page

Water Before Food | Optional

Use only what helps. The habit is the action, not another assignment.

My cue and action

> **Before I begin a main meal, i drink a full glass of water, within my individual fluid guidance.**

In my own words

Set up the environment

☐ A filled reusable bottle on my desk, in plain sight
☐ A bottle in the car for ordinary travel
☐ A glass beside the coffee maker
☐ A pitcher in the refrigerator at eye level
☐ An empty bottle in my travel bag, ready to fill

One change I will make

If this happens, I will do this

If	Then
I am at a restaurant	I ask for water before the food arrives.
The morning is rushed	I put my glass beside breakfast while the coffee warms.
I eat at work	I fill the bottle before I sit down.
My situation:	My plan:

Why this matters to me

For a difficult day: Put the permitted drink beside the meal before starting. If you have a prescribed fluid limit, agree on the action with your clinician.

Habit 1 Fourteen Day Record

Water Before Food

Mark ✓ when the action happened at that opportunity. In the last row, mark a day when it happened at most planned cues without special planning. Use N/A if there was no relevant cue; that is not a miss.

Cue / Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Breakfast														
Lunch														
Dinner														
Day worked														

Days that worked: _____ / 14 **Start date: _____**

The 11-of-14 check is a coaching guide. If cues were too few, observe longer. A missed action does not reset the record.

What I noticed

Did the glass change the pace of the meal, my hunger, or my first choice?

Where was the cue hardest to catch, and what would make it easier?

Optional experiment

try two days with water and unsweetened tea or coffee as your usual drinks. Notice your exposure to sweetness. Keep any drinks needed for nutrition, medication, or treatment; do not use this as a detox.

☐ Day 1 ☐ Day 2

What did I notice about my usual drinks?

My next step

☐ Keep practicing this cue ☐ Add the next habit when stable

One small success or change for next time

After a miss, return at the next ordinary cue. No compensation. No restart.

Habit 2 Practice Page

Protein First | Optional

Use only what helps. The habit is the action, not another assignment.

My cue and action

> **Before I decide anything else about a meal, i choose the protein source first.**

In my own words

Set up the environment

☐ Hard-boiled eggs ready in the refrigerator
☐ Cottage cheese or plain Greek yogurt as an easy option
☐ Cooked chicken or a suitable leftover protein
☐ Canned tuna, beans, or lentils in the pantry
☐ A labeled portion of protein powder and a shaker, if useful

One change I will make

If this happens, I will do this

If	Then
I am ordering at a restaurant	I choose the protein before choosing sides.
I am a guest	I identify the protein that is available, then build the rest of the meal.
I am traveling or short on time	I use a practical ready-to-eat protein or my planned backup.
My situation:	My plan:

Why this matters to me

For a difficult day: Identify one available protein for the meal. Planning is the habit; an exact gram target is not the assignment.

Habit 2 Fourteen Day Record

Protein First

Mark ✓ when the action happened at that opportunity. In the last row, mark a day when it happened at most planned cues without special planning. Use N/A if there was no relevant cue; that is not a miss.

Cue / Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Breakfast														
Lunch														
Dinner														
Day worked														

Days that worked: _____ / 14 **Start date: _____**

The 11-of-14 check is a coaching guide. If cues were too few, observe longer. A missed action does not reset the record.

What I noticed

Where does protein already appear in my breakfast?

How did hunger feel a few hours after the meal?

Optional experiment

record your usual protein for two days. Identify one realistic addition if needed. Do not force the top of a numerical range.

☐ Day 1 ☐ Day 2

Where is protein already present, and what is one realistic addition?

My next step

☐ Keep practicing this cue ☐ Add the next habit when stable

One small success or change for next time

After a miss, return at the next ordinary cue. No compensation. No restart.

Habit 3 Practice Page

Half the Plate | Optional

Use only what helps. The habit is the action, not another assignment.

My cue and action

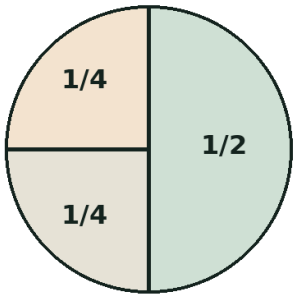
> **When I build a plate, i give vegetables about half the plate.**

In my own words

Set up the environment

☐ Frozen vegetables ready to cook
☐ Cut vegetables at eye level in the refrigerator
☐ A tray of roasted vegetables for the next few dinners
☐ Flavor I enjoy, such as garlic, lemon, chile, or a little Parmesan

One change I will make



1/2 vegetables

1/4 protein

1/4 higher-fiber starch

Adjust the plate to your needs.

If this happens, I will do this

If	Then
I am a guest	I offer to bring a vegetable dish I enjoy.
I eat at a restaurant	I look for a vegetable side that can fill more of the plate.
I eat fast food	I choose an available vegetable side or the closest workable option.
My situation:	My plan:

Why this matters to me

For a difficult day: Add the easiest available vegetable. If half a plate is not possible today, record the workable version and keep practicing.

Habit 3 Fourteen Day Record

Half the Plate

Mark ✓ when the action happened at that opportunity. In the last row, mark a day when it happened at most planned cues without special planning. Use N/A if there was no relevant cue; that is not a miss.

Cue / Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Lunch														
Dinner														
Day worked														

Days that worked: _____ / 14 Start date: _____

The 11-of-14 check is a coaching guide. If cues were too few, observe longer. A missed action does not reset the record.

What I noticed

Which vegetable is easiest for me to enjoy, and how do I prepare it?

What helped vegetables take up real space?

Optional experiment

prepare three kinds of vegetables you have not eaten in the last month. This is variety practice, not a microbiome test.

Three vegetables I tried and the preparation I enjoyed

My next step

☐ Keep practicing this cue ☐ Add the next habit when stable

One small success or change for next time

After a miss, return at the next ordinary cue. No compensation. No restart.

Habit 4 Practice Page

Sugar You Chose | Optional

Use only what helps. The habit is the action, not another assignment.

My cue and action

> **Before I eat or drink something with added sugar, i pause and decide whether I actually want it.**

In my own words

Set up the environment

☐ Move automatically eaten sweets out of immediate reach, by agreement in a shared home
☐ Keep fruit visible
☐ Keep plain yogurt and add fruit myself
☐ Keep an unsweetened drink I enjoy available

One change I will make

If this happens, I will do this

If	Then
I am at a party	I check what is in the drink rather than assuming it has no added sugar.
There is candy at work	I choose deliberately and avoid standing beside the bowl.
There is a birthday or holiday	I choose the treat I want, enjoy it, and return at the next meal.
My situation:	My plan:

Why this matters to me

For a difficult day: Make one conscious decision at the cue. Choosing to eat the sweet can count as practicing the habit.

Habit 4 Fourteen Day Record

Sugar You Chose

Mark ✓ when the action happened at that opportunity. In the last row, mark a day when it happened at most planned cues without special planning. Use N/A if there was no relevant cue; that is not a miss.

Cue / Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Noticed cue														
Chose mindfully														
Day worked														

Days that worked: _____ / 14 Start date: _____

The 11-of-14 check is a coaching guide. If cues were too few, observe longer. A missed action does not reset the record.

What I noticed

When does added sugar appear without a decision?

Which treats did I actually enjoy, and which did I eat because they were there?

Optional experiment

compare three products you buy. Read Added Sugars, serving size, and the ingredients. Note whether a sweetener appears near the start and compare a suitable alternative. Ingredient order is a clue, not a complete nutrition assessment.

Product	Added Sugars / serving	Sweetener near start?	Alternative

My next step

☐ Keep practicing this cue ☐ Add the next habit when stable

One small success or change for next time

After a miss, return at the next ordinary cue. No compensation. No restart.

Habit 5 Practice Page

Movement, Not Workouts | Optional

Use only what helps. The habit is the action, not another assignment.

My cue and action

> **After I finish my chosen meal, i take a ten-minute walk or the movement alternative agreed with my care team.**

In my own words

Set up the environment

☐ Walking shoes beside the door
☐ A chosen ten-minute route
☐ My phone or another step counter, if useful

One change I will make

If this happens, I will do this

If	Then
The weather is poor	I use a safe indoor route or an appropriate indoor alternative.
The day is packed	I use shorter movement bouts rather than waiting for an empty hour.
I am traveling	I walk somewhere safe instead of sitting through every wait.
My situation:	My plan:

Why this matters to me

For a difficult day: Choose a short, comfortable bout that is safe for me. Pain is information to address, not a cue to push harder.

Habit 5 Fourteen Day Record

Movement, Not Workouts

Mark ✓ when the action happened at that opportunity. In the last row, mark a day when it happened at most planned cues without special planning. Use N/A if there was no relevant cue; that is not a miss.

Cue / Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
My walk														
Day worked														

Days that worked: _____ / 14 Start date: _____

The 11-of-14 check is a coaching guide. If cues were too few, observe longer. A missed action does not reset the record.

What I noticed

How did I feel physically and mentally afterward?

What did I notice about my usual movement? A step average is optional.

Optional experiment

try walking during suitable phone calls for two days. Choose a safe place, remain aware of traffic, and use an accessible alternative when needed.

☐ Day 1 ☐ Day 2

Walking calls or an accessible alternative: what worked?

My next step

☐ Keep practicing this cue ☐ Add the next habit when stable

One small success or change for next time

After a miss, return at the next ordinary cue. No compensation. No restart.

Habit 6 Practice Page

Slower Carbs | Optional

Use only what helps. The habit is the action, not another assignment.

My cue and action

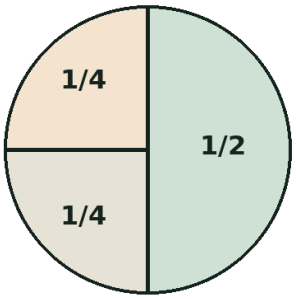
> **When I serve a starch, i choose a higher-fiber option and give it roughly a quarter of the plate, adjusted to my needs.**

In my own words

Set up the environment

☐ Two or three higher-fiber starches I enjoy, ready to use
☐ Bread or pita with a whole grain near the start of the ingredients
☐ Compare ingredients and fiber rather than only the front-of-package claim

One change I will make



1/2 vegetables

1/4 protein

1/4 higher-fiber starch

Adjust the plate to your needs.

If this happens, I will do this

If	Then
I face a holiday table	I choose the starch I most want, or deliberate small tastes, instead of automatic sampling.
I eat a sandwich or pizza	I choose the portion I want and add vegetables for some of the meal's volume.
It is a demanding training day	I adapt to my actual fueling needs rather than forcing the default plate.
My situation:	My plan:

Why this matters to me

For a difficult day: Choose the best available starch deliberately. The plate is a flexible visual guide, not a prescription.

Habit 6 Fourteen Day Record

Slower Carbs

Mark ✓ when the action happened at that opportunity. In the last row, mark a day when it happened at most planned cues without special planning. Use N/A if there was no relevant cue; that is not a miss.

Cue / Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Lunch														
Dinner														
Day worked														

Days that worked: _____ / 14 Start date: _____

The 11-of-14 check is a coaching guide. If cues were too few, observe longer. A missed action does not reset the record.

What I noticed

Which higher-fiber starch do I enjoy enough to keep as a default?

Which preparation or portion left the meal satisfying?

Optional experiment

notice how two dinners without a separate starch feel, only if that is suitable for you. A higher-fiber swap is an equally useful experiment. Do not reduce carbohydrate against medical or training guidance.

☐ Day 1 ☐ Day 2

What did I notice about the meals and the following mornings?

My next step

☐ Keep practicing this cue ☐ Add the next habit when stable

One small success or change for next time

After a miss, return at the next ordinary cue. No compensation. No restart.

Habit 7 Practice Page

Fat You Can See | Optional

Use only what helps. The habit is the action, not another assignment.

My cue and action

> **When I add fat to food, i measure the amount instead of free-pouring or scooping.**

In my own words

Set up the environment

☐ A measuring spoon beside the oil
☐ A controlled-pour bottle, if useful
☐ Small bowls for nuts where I usually sit
☐ Nut butter served on a plate instead of eaten from the jar

One change I will make

If this happens, I will do this

If	Then
I eat at a restaurant	I request dressing on the side when useful and serve it deliberately.
There are dips at a cookout	I choose the dips I want and put a portion on my plate.
I am cooking	I measure oil into the pan instead of pouring from the bottle.
My situation:	My plan:

Why this matters to me

For a difficult day: Measure one usual added fat and notice the amount. Keep practicing the full cue without making measurement a punishment.

Habit 7 Fourteen Day Record

Fat You Can See

Mark ✓ when the action happened at that opportunity. In the last row, mark a day when it happened at most planned cues without special planning. Use N/A if there was no relevant cue; that is not a miss.

Cue / Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Cooking oil														
Dressing / nuts														
Day worked														

Days that worked: _____ / 14 Start date: _____

The 11-of-14 check is a coaching guide. If cues were too few, observe longer. A missed action does not reset the record.

What I noticed

What surprised me when I measured?

Where was the portion larger than I had imagined?

Optional experiment

practice baking, roasting, steaming, or grilling for two days instead of frying. Notice which cooking choices were automatic. Fat remains part of the meal.

☐ Day 1 ☐ Day 2

Which cooking choices were automatic, and what worked instead?

My next step

☐ Keep practicing this cue ☐ Add the next habit when stable

One small success or change for next time

After a miss, return at the next ordinary cue. No compensation. No restart.

Habit 8 Practice Page

The Ten-Second Pause | Optional

Use only what helps. The habit is the action, not another assignment.

My cue and action

> **Before I eat something unplanned, i pause and count to ten, then choose what to do.**

In my own words

My usual cue: ☐ Stress ☐ Boredom ☐ Fatigue ☐ Reward

Set up the environment

☐ A visible list of five-minute alternatives
☐ Choose the place where I will pause: kitchen, couch, or cabinet
☐ Practice naming a feeling silently or aloud

One change I will make

If this happens, I will do this

If	Then
I find myself at the cabinet in the evening	I ask whether I need food, comfort, a break, or company.
I feel stressed	I name it: "I am stressed and looking for chocolate."
I choose to eat anyway	I eat without an argument with myself. Noticing was the practice.
My situation:	My plan:

Why this matters to me

For a difficult day: Notice one cue and take a conscious breath. A day with no unplanned-eating cue is not a failure.

Habit 8 Fourteen Day Record

The Ten-Second Pause

Mark ✓ when the action happened at that opportunity. In the last row, mark a day when it happened at most planned cues without special planning. Use N/A if there was no relevant cue; that is not a miss.

Cue / Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Paused														
Day worked														

Days that worked: _____ / 14 Start date: _____

The 11-of-14 check is a coaching guide. If cues were too few, observe longer. A missed action does not reset the record.

What I noticed

What was happening around me when the urge appeared?

What helped, and did I still want the food afterward?

Optional experiment

when the urge is emotional, try another useful action for five minutes, then decide again. If hungry, eat; do not use the pause to deny needed food.

When	What I felt	What I did

My five-minute alternative and what I chose afterward

My next step

☐ Keep practicing this cue ☐ Add the next habit when stable

One small success or change for next time

After a miss, return at the next ordinary cue. No compensation. No restart.

Another 14 Days

Reuse this page for any one habit.

At the end of each day, record the action at your planned cues. Use Yes, Part, No, or No cue. A day without a relevant cue is not a failure. Do not create an eating urge just to fill a box.

Day	Date	Action at planned cues	Small success or friction
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14			

Days the habit happened: _____ / 14 Days with no relevant cue: _____

The 11-of-14-days check is a coaching guide, not a validated scientific threshold. If there were too few opportunities to judge stability, extend the observation. Keep the record after a miss.

What helped it happen?

_____

What made it harder?

_____

One change for the next two weeks

_____

My decision: [ ] Keep practicing [ ] Add the next habit and keep this one running

After a Miss

The next cue is still available.

A missed action is something that happened, not a decision about who you are. Even if you have missed more than once, you can return without starting the whole method again.

What happened, described without blame

What made the action harder - time, setting, energy, or another need?

The next cue I can realistically catch

The ordinary action I will take then

One change that would make it easier

Keep recovery ordinary

- Do not skip a meal to compensate.
- Do not use exercise as payment for food.
- Do not restart all eight habits at once.
- Keep the record; one miss does not erase earlier practice.
- If the difficulty is bigger than a habit, ask for the support you need.

My Holiday Plan

Choose two anchors before the event.

Enjoyment and habit practice can share the same day. Choose what you want to keep available, then identify the next ordinary cue afterward.

Halloween

Candy at home, at work, or with the children: what will I choose, and where will the rest live?

My plan

Thanksgiving

Which foods matter to me? How will I handle seconds and leftovers without compensation?

My plan

Christmas or my year-end gatherings

Which two anchors can travel through parties, family meals, baking, and travel?

My plan

New Year

Which one habit needs attention, and what cue will I practice instead of starting a new diet?

My plan

My Event Calendar

An event is easier to plan for before the serving dish arrives.

Use this for birthdays, weddings, travel, a cookout, a religious holiday, or a busy work period. The anchors are behaviors you choose to keep, not restrictions you impose on the celebration.

Event and date	Two anchors	Next ordinary cue

One event I can prepare for this week

A Floor for a Difficult Week

Smaller can still be useful.

What is changing around me this week?

The one or two habits I can keep available

My smallest safe and realistic version

Food, equipment, or help I can arrange beforehand

Who I can ask for practical or emotional support

When I will review the plan

Illness, an injury, caregiving, or a mental health difficulty can change what is realistic. Follow professional guidance. Returning to a habit does not require pretending those conditions have disappeared.

My Personal Alert Plan

Optional. Use only if monitoring is helpful and emotionally neutral.

A prewritten decision can help you respond to a trend instead of one noisy morning. A personal weight range is a coaching tool, not a medical threshold. You can use a behavioral sign instead of weighing.

My sign that a habit needs attention

If useful, my personal range and how I will observe the trend

Some adults use an alert range about 5-7 pounds above their recent trend and review it after two consecutive weekly readings. This is not appropriate for everyone. A change in symptoms or medical advice takes priority; do not wait for a number to seek care.

The one habit I will review if I reach my alert point

Its cue and the action I will practice for the next two weeks

If weighing or body measurements become distressing, I will use this alternative

Support at Home

Share this page only if you want to.

The kind of support I would welcome

One practical change we agree on at home

One comment or kind of monitoring that does not help

An invitation I would enjoy - a walk, cooking together, or something else

What I want to keep private

If you are supporting someone else, ask rather than assume. Adults can share a meal without sharing a weight-loss goal. Children are not participants in this adult method.

Three Months and Six Months

Return to the starting point you chose.

What I notice	At the start	3 months	6 months
Afternoon energy			
Daily function or movement			
Fit of a familiar garment, if useful			
Waist or photograph, optional			

What changed that I did not measure

The habit that now feels most natural

The habit that currently needs a clearer cue

The change I want to try next

My Plan for Continuing

Keep what works. Give one worn habit attention.

The most useful thing I learned about myself

My strongest cue and the action attached to it

The environment change that did the most work

The next habit or adjustment I will practice

My next review date and one person I can turn to

There is no new starting line. At the next cue, do the next ordinary action.

Eight Cues to Keep

A reference page for the refrigerator or a notebook.

1. Water Before Food

Before I begin a main meal, i drink a full glass of water, within my individual fluid guidance.

2. Protein First

Before I decide anything else about a meal, i choose the protein source first.

3. Half the Plate

When I build a plate, i give vegetables about half the plate.

4. Sugar You Chose

Before I eat or drink something with added sugar, i pause and decide whether I actually want it.

5. Movement, Not Workouts

After I finish my chosen meal, i take a ten-minute walk or the movement alternative agreed with my care team.

6. Slower Carbs

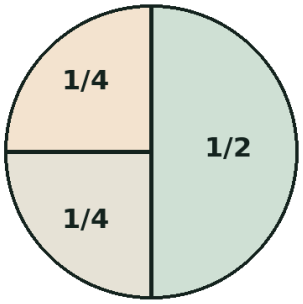
When I serve a starch, i choose a higher-fiber option and give it roughly a quarter of the plate, adjusted to my needs.

7. Fat You Can See

When I add fat to food, i measure the amount instead of free-pouring or scooping.

8. The Ten-Second Pause

Before I eat something unplanned, i pause and count to ten, then choose what to do.



1/2 vegetables

1/4 protein

1/4 higher-fiber starch

Adjust the plate to your needs.

Keep one required action per habit. The plate is a flexible adult starting point. Medical needs and safety take priority. After a miss, return at the next cue.

When More Support Would Help

A workbook cannot diagnose or treat an eating disorder or a crisis.

If eating feels out of control, restriction becomes severe, or distress keeps returning, speak with a qualified clinician. You do not need to complete this workbook before seeking help.

U.S. emotional support

Call or text 988, or use chat at https://988lifeline.org. The 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline provides free, confidential support 24/7 for emotional distress and mental health or substance-use crises. For immediate physical danger or a medical emergency, call 911.

Eating-disorder information and treatment referrals

National Alliance for Eating Disorders: 866-662-1235. Its website lists Monday-Friday, 9 a.m.-7 p.m. EST. The free helpline is staffed by licensed therapists. It is not a 24-hour crisis line. Check current hours at https://www.allianceforeatingdisorders.com. The treatment directory is https://findEDhelp.com.

Official information

988 Lifeline

SAMHSA

National Alliance

NIDDK on binge-eating disorder

Service details reviewed October 30, 2026. The book supplies the scientific references. The 14-day record, 11-of-14 guide, and return-after-a-miss exercises are coaching tools, not validated medical tests.

Notes

Ideas and observations to return to